boolean ocidefinebyname(integer statement, string column, reference variable, integer type)

The ocidefinebyname function associates a column with a PHP variable. When the statement is executed, the value of the column will be copied into the variable. The statement argument must be an integer returned by ociparse. The column name must be written in upper case, otherwise Oracle will not recognize it. Unrecognized column names do not produce errors. Since the variable you pass in ocidefinebyname will be modified, you need to pass it by reference. That mean preceding it with an ampersand (&).

The type argument appears to be necessary only if you are attaching to an abstract data type, such as a ROWID. Abstract data types require ocinewdescriptor be used prior to ocidefinebyname. If the type argument is left out, the variable will be set as a nullterminated string.

```
<?
        //connect to database
        $Connection = ocilogon("scott", "tiger");

        //assemble query
        $Query = "SELECT ENAME, HIREDATE ";
        $Query .= "FROM emp ";
        $Query .= "WHERE JOB='CLERK' ";

        //parse query
        $Statement = ociparse($Connection, $Query);

    //associate two columns with variables
    ocidefinebyname($Statement, "ENAME", &$EmployeeName);
    ocidefinebyname($Statement, "HIREDATE", &$HireDate);

    //execute query
    ociexecute($Statement);

    //fetch each row
    while(ocifetch($Statement))
    {
          print("$EmployeeName was hired $HireDate<BR>\n");
    }
        //free the statement
        ocifreestatement($Statement);

        //close connection
        ocilogoff($Connection);
?>
```